
The Stars & Their Notes

A MUSICAL MISCELLANY • FROM THE PAGES OF THE PARLOUR GAZETTE

We wrote to thirty-two celebrated persons and asked each of them two impertinent questions: which air from The Parlour Songbook they play most often, and which two note shapes in it they hold dearest. To our astonishment, all thirty-two replied. Their answers are printed below without correction.

TAYLOR SWIFT

"I write the bridge first and the rest of the song is just an excuse for it."

Favourite air: **March of the Small Paintings.**

Favourite notes: the quarter rest, then the single eighth note.

HARRY STYLES

"A note is only as good as the trousers you play it in."

Favourite air: **The Painter's Gavotte.**

Favourite notes: the grace note, then the pair of beamed eighth notes.

BEYONCÉ

"Every rest is a choice."

Favourite air: **The Tram to Brunswick.**

Favourite notes: the quarter note, then the quarter rest.

DOLLY PARTON

"A rest is just a note that's thinking."

Favourite air: **Farewell to the Fourth Floor.**

Favourite notes: the flattened note, then the pair of beamed eighth notes.

ELTON JOHN

"I have a piano in every room and a favourite note in every piano."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the two tied quarter notes, then the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop).

BILLIE EILISH

"Quiet notes are louder."

Favourite air: **March of the Small Paintings.**

Favourite notes: the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop), then the sixteenth rest.

ADELE

"If it doesn't make somebody cry, add a dot to it."

Favourite air: **The Fire-Escape Waltz.**

Favourite notes: the dotted half note, then the dotted quarter note.

BRUNO MARS

"Play it twice, and the second time wear a hat."

Favourite air: **Hymn to the Dishwasher.**

Favourite notes: the sharpened note, then the half note.

LADY GAGA

"I was born with this note."

Favourite air: **Song of the Sock Drawer.**

Favourite notes: the flattened note, then the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop).

RIHANNA

"I don't play the notes. The notes play me, and they pay for the privilege."

Favourite air: **Waltz for a Geneticist.**

Favourite notes: the single sixteenth note, then the half rest.

HOZIER

"There is a church somewhere that owes me this note."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the staccato note, then the grace note.

OLIVIA RODRIGO

"This is the note I'd play at my ex's wedding."

Favourite air: **The Painter's Gavotte.**

Favourite notes: the grace note, then the pair of beamed eighth notes.

STEVIE WONDER

"You can hear a smile in a triplet."

Favourite air: **Waltz for a Geneticist.**

Favourite notes: the grace note, then the single sixteenth note.

SABRINA CARPENTER

"Short, sweet, and it leaves before you're ready."

Favourite air: **Lullaby for a Houseplant.**

Favourite notes: the two tied quarter notes, then the staccato note.

PAUL McCARTNEY

"John never liked this one, which is why I play it."

Favourite air: **Waltz for a Geneticist.**

Favourite notes: the two-note chord, then the grace note.

CHAPPELL ROAN

"Loud, pink, and in the wrong key on purpose."

Favourite air: **Song of the Sock Drawer.**

Favourite notes: the dotted eighth and sixteenth (the gallop), then the staccato note.

BAD BUNNY

"Any note is a dance note if you commit."

Favourite air: **Serenade for the Last Slice.**

Favourite notes: the staccato note, then the eighth rest.

PHOEBE BRIDGERS

"It's the sad one. Obviously it's the sad one."

Favourite air: **The Sunday Crossword Rag.**

Favourite notes: the pair of beamed eighth notes, then the half note.

KEANU REEVES

"I don't play. I listen. This one's nice."

Favourite air: **Lullaby for a Houseplant.**

Favourite notes: the eighth-note triplet, then the staccato note.

LIZZO

"I play this on the flute while doing something else entirely."

Favourite air: **The Milkmaid's Lament.**

Favourite notes: the pair of beamed sixteenths, then the staccato note.

SHAKIRA

"The notes don't lie."

Favourite air: **The Copy-Shop Reel.**

Favourite notes: the run of four beamed sixteenths, then the grace note.

ZENDAYA

"I was told to pick one, so I picked two."

Favourite air: **The Painter's Gavotte.**

Favourite notes: the staccato note, then the pair of beamed sixteenths.

CÉLINE DION

"I hold this note until the room agrees with me."

Favourite air: **Coffee at Dawn.**

Favourite notes: the pair of beamed sixteenths, then the two-note chord.

BRUCE SPRINGSTEEN

"Four bars of this and the whole county shows up."

Favourite air: **The Copy-Shop Reel.**

Favourite notes: the dotted half note, then the two tied quarter notes.

KACEY MUSGRAVES

"Slow it down and it turns into a porch."

Favourite air: **The Copy-Shop Reel.**

Favourite notes: the pair of beamed sixteenths, then the run of four beamed sixteenths.

ED SHEERAN

"I could play this one in any coffee shop in the world, and I have."

Favourite air: **The Barista's Hornpipe.**

Favourite notes: the dotted half note, then the pair of beamed eighth notes.

NOAH KAHAN

"It's the sound of leaving Vermont and coming straight back."

Favourite air: **The Milkmaid's Lament.**

Favourite notes: the quarter note, then the staccato note.

TOM HANKS

"I don't know what it's called, but I like the look of it."

Favourite air: **Serenade for the Last Slice.**

Favourite notes: the staccato note, then the pair of beamed eighth notes.

DOJA CAT

"I don't have a favourite note. Fine. Two."

Favourite air: **The Fire-Escape Waltz.**

Favourite notes: the eighth-note triplet, then the dotted eighth note.

CHARLI XCX

"Fast. Faster than that."

Favourite air: **Coffee at Dawn.**

Favourite notes: the half rest, then the single eighth note.

PEDRO PASCAL

"I would protect this note with my life."

Favourite air: **Air for a Rainy Tuesday.**

Favourite notes: the run of four beamed sixteenths, then the quarter note.

MITSKI

"It's a rest. Let it rest."

Favourite air: **The Landlord's Jig.**

Favourite notes: the two-note chord, then the two tied quarter notes.